Academic integrity: a guide for students

Quality. September 1052. Plain-language guide to Part G of the Academic Regulations and the Academic Integrity Policy.

The idea

Your work is yours. When you use someone else's words, ideas or data, you say so. When you work with others, you only do it where the brief allows. When you use a tool, you use it the way the brief allows and you say you have.

The things that get students into trouble

- **Plagiarism.** Using someone else's words or ideas without saying where they came from. Including your own earlier work, if you submit it twice.
- **Collusion.** Working together on something that was meant to be done alone. Sharing your work with a friend "to look at" counts if they then submit bits of it.
- **Contract cheating.** Getting someone, or something, to do the work for you. Buying an essay. Asking a tool to write it.
- **Fabrication.** Making up data, quotations or references.
- **AI tools.** Every assessment brief tells you whether and how you may use them. Read it. If you may use a tool, you must say how you used it. If the brief says no, no.

What happens if you are suspected

Your marker will not mark the work. The Faculty's Academic Integrity Officer will look at it. For a first, minor case in Year 1 you will usually get feedback and no penalty. Otherwise there is a panel, you can bring someone with you, and the penalties go from a warning up to, for the worst cases, being asked to leave.

On a regulated programme, dishonesty is also a fitness to practise matter.

How to stay out of trouble

Reference everything. Keep your drafts. Do not share your files. Read the brief's line about AI tools and follow it. If you are not sure, ask your module leader before the deadline, not after.